

VRTERNATIVES

There's more to VR than meets the eye



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We normally think of VR as something that's purely for entertainment; for consuming media content, be it watching movies or playing games. However, there are plenty more uses to VR outside of gaming or media, which we'll be covering in

this segment of the cover story. Keep in mind that widespread adoption of VR is still in process, and a lot of these uses require for VR to be more mainstream and readily available, even though they are already being used in these fields to an extent.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

One of the key areas where VR can make a big difference is in education and training. It has been known that interactive education sticks better

than traditional methods. And what better medium than VR to make education the most interactive and immersive experience ever! Being able to virtually interact with the subject matter being taught could greatly help improve the quality of education. Subjects like chemistry could become a lot safer to practise, allowing for the more dangerous experiments to be observed virtually. Physics would become easier to explain with visual aids. Studying about space while being able to observe the solar system and the milky way could be thrilling. What better way to learn about history than to be in a simulation of that very time period? You get our point.

In general, education could become a lot more fun with the involvement of VR.

Then there's training. VR is already being used to help medical students train and has already seen positive results when it comes to helping them master procedures. Training for difficult onsite jobs becomes much easier with VR,



allowing you to experience the work virtually beforehand. There are many merits to using VR this way for training; you minimise the risk of actual danger or harm to the person involved, and you also minimise financial risk by not needing to risk untrained personnel using expensive equipment.

VR is also used by NASA, including full body haptic suits, to help not only track astronaut biometrics, but also help them actually feel the environments they might one day experience.

TRAVEL

VR could be a great way to experience far away locations and go on virtual tours. Furthermore, in the virtual

